

Reviewer Guide

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This is the second review layer. You validate the golden solution, metadata, and test coverage.

1

Verify Pre-Validation passes

Confirm the Helix Pre-Validation CI checks are green on the golden-solution PR.

If checks failed or are still pending, send the task back to the fellow. Do not proceed with review until checks pass.

Red flags: Checks failed. Checks stuck in pending for an extended period. No checks triggered at all.

2

Read metadata

Open `.helix/metadata.json` and evaluate:

problem_statement — Is it clear, specific, and detailed enough for an AI agent to understand the bug or feature? Does it name files, functions, and expected behavior? Could a model read this with access to the codebase and know exactly what to do?

hints — Are relevant file paths, function names, or error messages included? Hints should guide the agent toward the right area of the codebase without giving away the solution.

Check for placeholders — Fields must not contain empty strings, "TODO", "N/A", "handshake", or other placeholder values. Every field should be filled with real, task-specific content.

3

Validate FAIL_TO_PASS tests

Review the FAIL_TO_PASS field:

Are the listed test files actually testing the fix introduced in this PR?

Do the test names and paths make sense for the problem described?

Cross-reference with the [sol] commit to ensure the tests align with the code changes.

Red flags: Tests that would pass without the solution applied. Tests unrelated to the problem statement. Test paths that don't exist in the repo. Duplicate tests that don't add coverage.

4

Check commit structure

Verify the PR has the correct commit order:

[dep] (*optional*) — Dependency or infrastructure changes

[sol] — Feature or fix code only (no test files)

[f2p] — Test changes only (fail-to-pass tests)

[meta] — Metadata updates only

The [sol] commit must not contain test files. The [f2p] commit must not contain non-test code changes. Three commits is the standard; four is acceptable only when [dep] is needed.

Red flags: Mixed code and tests in a single commit. Wrong commit order. Extra commits beyond the allowed set.

5

PR quality

Verify PR formatting:

Title starts with [GOLDEN SOLUTION]

Description covers **Problem, Approach,** and **Testing strategy**

A well-written PR description helps future reviewers and serves as documentation. If the description is missing or generic, request changes.

See the Scoring rubric in the [Platform Basics](#) tab for grading criteria.

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